Case Title: Whitaker v. Orion Logistics Inc.
Case Number: 2025-CV-4412
Court: United States District Court, Eastern District of Texas
Date: June 18, 2025
Plaintiff: Elena Whitaker
Defendant: Orion Logistics Inc.

Summary:
Plaintiff Elena Whitaker filed suit against Orion Logistics Inc. alleging wrongful termination and unpaid overtime wages under the Fair Labor Standards Act following her dismissal on April 2, 2025.

Background:
Whitaker worked as a freight coordinator for Orion Logistics from March 2021 until April 2025. She alleges she regularly worked 55 hours per week but was compensated only for 40 hours. After she reported the discrepancy to the Department of Labor, she was terminated within eleven days of filing that complaint.

Legal Arguments:
Plaintiff's Claims:
Retaliation: Termination followed protected whistleblower activity.
Unpaid Overtime: Orion failed to pay time-and-a-half for 15 hours of weekly overtime across approximately 210 weeks of employment.

Defendant's Defense:
Orion argues Whitaker was an exempt administrative employee and that her termination resulted from documented performance issues unrelated to the Department of Labor complaint.

Court Decision:
The court ruled in favor of the plaintiff on both counts. The court found the eleven-day gap between the complaint and the termination established a prima facie case of retaliation that Orion failed to rebut, and that Whitaker did not meet the administrative exemption.

Final Judgment:
Orion Logistics Inc. is ordered to pay Elena Whitaker $148,500 in back wages, liquidated damages, and attorney fees within 45 days. Case Closed.